



REVIEW

ROXX STAR

THE THAR ROXX COMBINES LUXURY WITH PERFORMANCE TO MAKE A STRONG STATEMENT IN THE MID-SIZE SUV SEGMENT

BY CHETAN BHUTANI

BIGGER AND BETTER. That is one way of describing the Mahindra Thar Roxx in comparison to its predecessor. And Mahindra seems to have taken the feedback of customers seriously to make these enhancements. The Thar Roxx, which comes in 14 variants with both diesel and petrol engines, retains the classic rugged appeal of its predecessor while introducing new design elements such as the six-slat grille and C-shaped LED taillights, giving it a modern touch. But the roofline around the B-pillar looks a bit awkward. The five-door Roxx is longer than the original Thar by 443 mm, with 400 mm added between the axles. It is also 50 mm wider and 66 mm taller than the three-door Thar, providing a more commanding stance on the road.

I took the Everest White AX7 L Petrol Automatic out for a spin in Kochi. As I stepped in, the cockpit felt fresh and inviting, thanks to a new touchscreen and digital instrument cluster; the dashboard uses soft-touch materials. Leatherette seats, a lighter and bigger steering wheel (similar to the ones in the XUV700 and the Scorpio N), and white upholstery contribute to a premium feel (but

can get dirty). Storage, however, remains a concern. The glove box is small, and the door pockets are tiny. And getting into the second row is cumbersome despite the doors, as the opening is narrow; besides, the elderly might face a problem lifting themselves onto these seats.

Under the hood, the Roxx impresses with its engine, which is responsive even at low speeds. Both city driving and highway cruising are smooth and enjoyable. The power build-up is linear, and thanks to improved noise, vibration, and harshness (NVH) levels, the cabin remains quiet and comfortable even at higher speeds. The ladder-on-frame construction, while robust, does lead to a slightly bouncy ride at low speeds, but it's better than the original Thar. The extended wheelbase and better tyres contribute to a more stable and comfortable ride over potholes.

With features like a panoramic sunroof, wireless charging, and modern infotainment options, the Thar Roxx manages to strike a balance between being a capable off-roader and a practical family vehicle, with scope for improvement. Prices start from ₹12.99 lakh and goes up to ₹20.49 lakh. The Thar Roxx is a strong contender in the mid-size SUV market that has popular models like the Hyundai Creta, the Kia Seltos, the Volkswagen Taigun, the Skoda Kushaq, and the Force Gurkha five-door. **BT**

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